



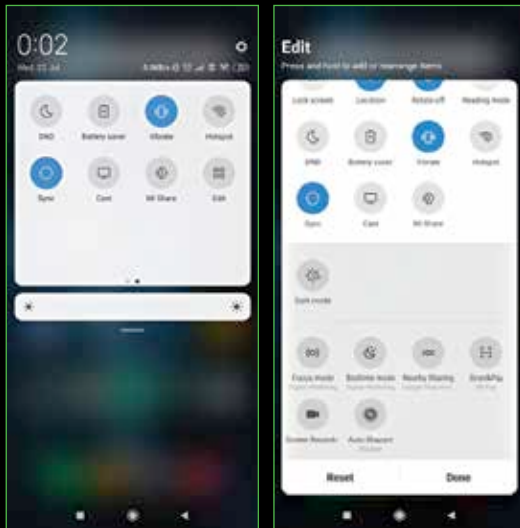
Google tracking users

Google is apparently using internal tools to keep tabs on the personal data that users keep on their devices. <https://digit.in/aug20-49>



Snoop tracking app

This nifty little app shows a small green dot to indicate when an app is using the camera or mic on your phone. <https://digit.in/aug20-50>



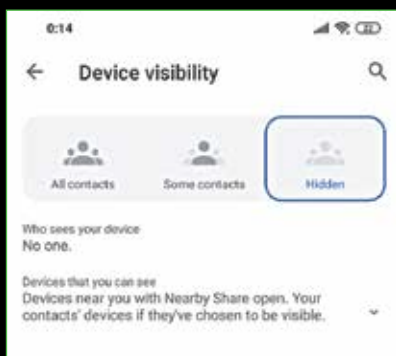
The Edit button to show inactive tiles (left) and the Nearby Share toggle in the inactive tiles (right)

three-dot menu to change 'Button Order'. The image above shows what it looks like on a Pocofone F1.

Now, search for the 'Nearby Share' tile among the list of inactive tiles. Note that if you don't see the Nearby Share tile anywhere, you will probably have to wait longer for a server-side update to be able to use it on your device. So, keep checking the inactive tiles in your Quick Settings menu at regular intervals. Once you find the Nearby Share tile, drag and drop it where all the active tiles are placed. That's it, you now have the Nearby Share toggle within your Quick Settings that you can turn on and off as needed.

TWEAK SOME SETTINGS

Now, you can set up a few things in order to use Nearby Share exactly



Choose between 'All Contacts', 'Some Contacts' and 'Hidden' as your device visibility setting

how you intend to. Google has implemented a couple of security measures to safeguard users from unwanted transfers. You can tweak the Nearby Share settings as per your preference by long-pressing the Nearby Share toggle in your Quick Settings menu and entering the Nearby Share settings page. If you haven't added the Nearby Share toggle, simply go to your phone's Settings app. Then navigate to Google. Click on Device connections and then find and click on Nearby Share. You will have entered the settings page of Nearby Share.

First, select 'Device visibility' to configure who will be able to view your phone in their Nearby Share menu and send you items. If you set this to 'All Contacts', anyone near your device will be able to see your device and send files. You will still have to hit 'Accept' before actually receiving the file. On your end, you will also be able to see every nearby device in your vicinity, if they have also chosen to be visible to you.

Choosing 'Some Contacts' will essentially limit your visibility to a few specific people that you choose. Google will recommend your starred contacts to be added to this list. Also, in this mode, anyone on your contact list who has chosen to be visible to you will be seen. Finally, if you choose 'Hidden', everyone will be blocked from seeing you on their list. You will, however, be able to see everyone with Nearby Share enabled (if they have chosen to be visible to you). It is advisable to use this option in places where you don't want to share

files, such as trains, public parks, etc. to protect yourself from potential spam.

Next, you can also choose if the data is to be transferred over cellular data, Wi-Fi, or Wi-Fi Direct. To change this, go back to the Nearby Share settings page and then choose 'Data usage'. Now, click on the option you prefer. 'Data' will transfer small files over cellular data, 'Wi-Fi only' will never use cellular data to share, and 'Without Internet' will disable sharing data over cellular or Wi-Fi and will solely rely on Wi-Fi Direct to complete the transfer.

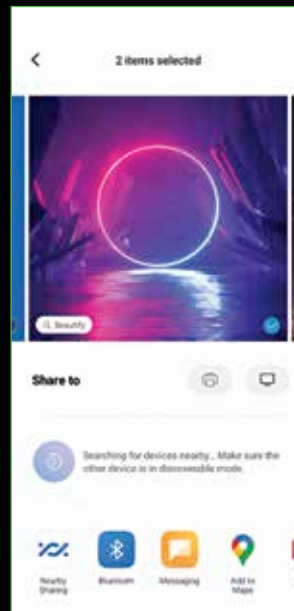
SEND A FILE TO A NEARBY ANDROID DEVICE

Now, moving onto the actual functionality of the feature, sharing files or links. In any app, you can select a file or a link you want to share with a

friend nearby. Click the share button that you usually use to send things over WhatsApp or Email. Now, scroll through the options and you should be able to see a new 'Nearby Share' option.

Once you select 'Nearby Share', you will be prompted to turn on three sensors, the Wi-Fi, Bluetooth and Location sensors. Select 'Turn on' to enable them, or you can even manually enable these beforehand. Next, you will see a prompt that displays all devices within range. Select the person who you

want to share the file with. A notification will pop up on the receiver's phone asking them to accept the file. If they choose 'Accept', the file will be sent to their device directly. The file will be stored in their 'Download' folder in the File Manager they use. If you share a link or say a Tweet, the corresponding app will directly open up and display what you shared.



Click Nearby Share in your sharing options